

CRESCITA

COLLECTIVE

BY GRACE WE GROW

MEMBER GUIDED SELF-ASSESSMENT & ACCOUNTABILITY

CHANGE THE ENDING

SEPTEMBER 2026

THE YEAR ISN'T OVER. NEITHER ARE YOU.

Philippians 3:13-14 NIV

Brothers and sisters, I do not consider myself yet to have taken hold of it. But one thing I do: Forgetting what is behind and straining toward what is ahead, I press on toward the goal to win the prize for which God has called me heavenward in Christ Jesus.

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THIS ISSUE

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Five sections. One month. No performance required — only honesty.

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SECTION 1

01

CHANGE THE ENDING

*There is enough of the year behind you to see the pattern — and enough
ahead to intervene.*

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There comes a point in every year when it becomes easy to accept the shape it has taken. The plans that never quite became habits. The goals that were important in January but gradually disappeared beneath work, stress, distraction or ordinary life. The conversations that were postponed, the decisions that were avoided, and the things we promised ourselves we would eventually change.

By September, eight months of evidence sit behind us. That can be useful, but it can also become dangerous. We begin to treat what has already happened as proof of what the rest of the year must look like. A difficult season becomes a difficult year. A few failed attempts become evidence that something cannot be done. Lost momentum begins to feel permanent.

It isn't.

The year is not over, and nothing about the months behind you requires the months ahead to look the same.

That does not mean pretending January through August never happened. A fresh start is not an act of forgetting. It is an act of using what you now know.

You know more about yourself than you did at the beginning of the year. You have seen which environments bring out your best and which ones drain you. You have discovered which intentions survived contact with reality and which ones did not. You may have learned where you are disciplined, where you make excuses, where you need support, and where you have been waiting for circumstances to change before allowing yourself to move.

All of that is information. The question now is what you are going to do with it.

September offers a useful threshold. There is enough of the year behind you to see the patterns clearly, but enough of it still ahead to intervene. You cannot rewrite the beginning of this year, but you can still influence its ending.

This is about looking carefully at where you are, deciding what still matters, and changing direction where change is required.

THE QUESTION FOR SEPTEMBER

As you work through this month, return to one question:

IF THE YEAR WERE GOING TO END DIFFERENTLY, WHAT WOULD HAVE TO CHANGE NOW?

Not eventually. Not when circumstances are easier. Not when you feel completely ready. Now.

You may discover that the answer is practical: a habit needs rebuilding, a project needs finishing, money needs managing differently, your health needs more attention.

You may discover that the answer is internal: an old story needs questioning, resentment needs releasing, fear has been making too many decisions, or you have been measuring yourself against a version of life that no longer fits.

Sometimes changing the ending requires doing more. Sometimes it requires stopping. Sometimes it requires returning to something you abandoned too quickly. And sometimes it requires accepting that a particular chapter has already taught you what it came to teach.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

The most useful thing you can bring to these pages is honesty. Not self-criticism. Not exaggerated positivity. Not the version of the answer you think you should give. Honesty.

Judgement says, "I should be further ahead by now." Observation asks, "What has actually been happening, and why?" One closes the conversation. The other gives you somewhere to work from.

As you move through this programme, resist the instinct to make your answers impressive. There is no audience here. A short truthful answer will always be more useful than a polished one.

THE SEPTEMBER PRINCIPLE

**GRACE GIVES YOU ROOM TO BEGIN AGAIN.
DISCIPLINE DECIDES WHAT YOU DO WITH IT.**

There is grace in being allowed to change your mind, reconsider your direction, admit that something is not working, or begin later than you intended. Beginning again is not evidence that you failed.

But grace is not the same thing as passivity. A new beginning only becomes meaningful when something in your behaviour changes with it.

You can forgive yourself for losing momentum and still rebuild the routine. You can accept that you made the wrong decision and still take responsibility for making the next one differently. You can acknowledge that circumstances were difficult without surrendering every part of your agency to them.

Both things can be true at once.

YOUR INTENTION

Before moving into the diagnostic section, take a moment to consider what would make September meaningful to you. Do not try to capture your entire life. Think instead about the difference you would genuinely like to notice thirty days from now.

By the end of September, I want to be able to say:

If nothing changes this month, what am I most likely to regret?

You do not need unlimited time to change direction. You need enough time to make one different decision, then another.

**THERE IS STILL TIME
TO CHANGE THE ENDING.**

SECTION 2

02

THE HONEST INVENTORY

A feeling is not a diagnosis. Before you change direction, get an accurate picture of where you are.

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Before you can change direction, you need an accurate picture of where you are. That sounds obvious, but most people do not actually operate from an accurate picture of their lives. We tell ourselves things are “fine,” “a mess,” “getting better,” or “not where they should be,” but those descriptions are usually too vague to be useful.

A feeling is not a diagnosis.

This section asks you to stop looking at your year as one large emotional summary and instead look at the individual areas that make up your life. The purpose is not to score yourself and then feel good or bad about it — the numbers are simply a way of forcing clarity.

You are looking for patterns. Where are you strong? Where are you drifting? Where are you compensating? Where are you pretending something matters while consistently behaving as if it does not? Where are you doing better than you give yourself credit for?

PART ONE — WHERE ARE YOU NOW?

Rate each area of your life from 1 to 10 based on how it genuinely feels and functions at the moment. Score according to what is actually happening, not what you think should matter most. A low score is not a failure. A high score is not proof there is nothing left to improve. You are establishing a baseline.

MIND

How clear, stable and intentional does your inner world feel? Think about your ability to focus, regulate your attention, make decisions, manage pressure and recognise when your thoughts are helping or undermining you.

SCORE: 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 /10

What influenced this score?

BODY

How well are you currently caring for the physical part of your life? Consider sleep, movement, energy, food, recovery and your general relationship with your body. Score according to stewardship, not appearance.

SCORE: 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 /10

What influenced this score?

WORK + PURPOSE

How aligned do you feel with the work you are doing and the direction you are moving in? This can include employment, business, study, creative work, or responsibilities at home. Do your days feel connected to something meaningful, or are you simply getting through them?

SCORE: 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 /10

What influenced this score?

FINANCES

How much clarity and control do you currently have around your money? Not how much you earn — whether your financial behaviour supports the life you are trying to build.

SCORE: 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 /10

What influenced this score?

RELATIONSHIPS

How healthy and intentional do your important relationships currently feel? Consider family, friendship, partnership, work relationships and how you are showing up for the people around you.

SCORE: 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 /10

What influenced this score?

DISCIPLINE

How often are you doing what you said you would do? Not perfectly. Consistently. This includes the promises nobody else knows you made.

SCORE: 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 /10

What influenced this score?

FAITH + INNER ALIGNMENT

How connected do you currently feel to something larger than immediate pressure, achievement or circumstance? Score according to connection, not performance.

SCORE: 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 /10

What influenced this score?

CONTRIBUTION

How much of your life currently extends beyond yourself? This does not have to mean money or formal volunteering — it can mean supporting someone, showing up, or being available where you are needed.

SCORE: 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 /10

What influenced this score?

PART TWO — READ THE PATTERN, NOT JUST THE NUMBERS

Now look at your scores together. Do not rush toward the lowest number — sometimes the lowest score is the symptom rather than the source. A low work score might be connected to exhaustion. A low discipline score might be connected to a lack of direction. Financial stress may be affecting relationships. Your life does not operate in isolated categories — it operates as a system.

Which area currently feels strongest? Why do you think it's working?

Which area feels weakest? What has contributed to that?

Which score surprised you? Why?

Where do you think one problem is creating problems somewhere else?

Which area, if improved, would create the biggest positive effect across the rest of your life?

PART THREE — THE GAP BETWEEN INTENTION AND BEHAVIOUR

Most people already know, at least roughly, what matters to them. The difficulty is not always knowledge. The difficulty is alignment. We say health matters, then consistently sacrifice sleep. Life fills whatever space we fail to govern deliberately.

I SAY THIS MATTERS — list three things you regularly say are important to you.

What does my current behaviour suggest actually matters?

Take a moment with the difference between those two lists. You do not need to attack yourself for the gap. But you do need to see it — because the life you eventually build will be shaped far more by repeated behaviour than by stated intention.

PART FOUR — WHAT HAS THIS YEAR BEEN TEACHING YOU?

Eight months is long enough for patterns to reveal themselves. Some lessons arrive through progress. Others arrive through repetition — the same difficulty keeps returning because the lesson has not yet been acted upon.

What has repeatedly demanded my attention?

What have I learned about myself under pressure?

What have I discovered I need more of?

What do I now know I need less of?

What have I continued tolerating even though I know it is costing me something?

Where have I grown, even if the growth was uncomfortable?

THE QUESTION BENEATH THE QUESTION

Imagine nothing changed between now and the end of the year. The same routines. The same decisions. The same avoidance. Where would that trajectory take you — not where do you hope it takes you, but where does the evidence suggest it takes you?

If I continue exactly as I am, by December I am likely to feel:

If I make the changes I already know are necessary, by December I could reasonably be:

The distance between those two answers is where the rest of this programme will focus. You do not need to fix every score. You need to understand what deserves intervention.

SECTION 3

03

THE STORY YOU KEEP REPEATING

You can fail at something without becoming a failure. Separate what happened from the meaning you assigned to it.

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Underneath repeated behaviour, there is usually a repeated interpretation. A story — something you have started to believe about yourself, your circumstances, your ability, your future, or what is possible for you.

Sometimes those stories are obvious: “I am not disciplined enough.” “Nothing ever works out for me.” “I am too far behind.” Other stories are quieter — they don't sound dramatic enough to notice, but they still influence decisions: “This is probably not the right time.” “I need to know exactly what I am doing before I begin.”

Repeated often enough, these ideas stop feeling like interpretations and begin to feel like facts. That is when they become dangerous — not because every difficult thought is false, but because once a thought becomes part of your identity, you stop examining whether it is still useful, accurate or complete.

WHEN AN EXPERIENCE BECOMES AN IDENTITY

You can fail at something without becoming a failure. You can lose discipline without becoming an undisciplined person. You can make a poor financial decision without being “bad with money.” Yet this is one of the easiest psychological shortcuts to make.

An event happens. We interpret it. The interpretation becomes a belief. The belief starts shaping behaviour. Then the behaviour produces new evidence that appears to confirm the original belief. That is a loop — and loops do not usually disappear simply because we want a different outcome. They have to be interrupted.

PART ONE — WHAT HAVE YOU STARTED BELIEVING?

Think about the year so far. Not only what happened, but what you have concluded because it happened. Complete the following honestly.

Because of what has happened this year, I have started believing that:

When something goes wrong, the story I tend to tell myself is:

The sentence I repeat internally when I am discouraged is:

Something I have quietly decided is “probably not for me” is:

One label I have been placing on myself is:

**IS THIS A FACT,
OR IS THIS AN INTERPRETATION?**

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN FACT AND STORY

Suppose you applied for three opportunities and none of them worked out. The fact is: three applications were unsuccessful. The story might become: nobody wants what I have to offer. Those are not the same statement.

Suppose you intended to exercise four times a week and stopped after two. The fact is: the routine did not last. The story might become: I have no discipline. The first statement gives you something specific to investigate. The second turns a behavioural problem into an identity.

When you catch yourself using words like always, never, everyone, nobody, or just the way I am, pay attention. Absolute language often hides an interpretation pretending to be evidence.

PART TWO — THE EVIDENCE TEST

The belief:

What experiences made me believe this?

What evidence supports it?

What evidence complicates or contradicts it?

Are there situations where this belief is not true?

If someone I respected described themselves this way, would I consider the statement completely accurate? Why or why not?

The purpose of this exercise is not to prove that every negative belief is wrong. There is an enormous difference between saying “I have been inconsistent lately” and “I am an inconsistent

person.” One describes behaviour. The other declares a permanent identity. Behaviour can be changed.

THE STORIES THAT PROTECT US

Not every limiting belief exists because we are pessimistic. Some exist because they protect us. If you believe you are not ready, you do not have to risk beginning. If you believe success is mostly luck, you do not have to confront whether your current effort is sufficient.

A belief that protects you from discomfort can also protect you from change.

PART THREE — WHAT IS THE STORY DOING FOR YOU?

The story I keep returning to is:

If I continue believing this, what does it allow me to avoid?

What responsibility does this story remove from me?

What risk does it protect me from taking?

What is it costing me?

PART FOUR — CHANGE THE LANGUAGE

Mindset is often discussed as though it means replacing every difficult thought with a positive one. That is usually neither believable nor useful. Instead, look for language that is both honest and open.

Rather than: “I have no discipline.”

Try: “My discipline has been inconsistent, and I can rebuild it through smaller repeated actions.”

Rather than: “I always mess up opportunities.”

Try: “Some opportunities have not worked out. I need to understand what was within my control and improve it.”

Rather than: “It is too late for this year.”

Try: “I have less time than I had in January, but I still have time to change my trajectory.”

Rather than: “This is just who I am.”

Try: “This is how I have been behaving.”

Small difference. Completely different implication. One closes the future. The other leaves room for responsibility.

REWRITE THE STORY

OLD STORY 01

More accurate version

OLD STORY 02

More accurate version

OLD STORY 03

More accurate version

PART FIVE — THE MINDSET YOU ARE CARRYING FORWARD

You do not need a completely different personality to finish the year differently. But you may need a different relationship with your own thinking. Consider the mindset you want to practise through the final months — not an affirmation, a principle.

For the rest of this year, I want to remember:

ONE BELIEF TO LEAVE HERE

The belief I am choosing to stop obeying is:

When it appears again, I will remind myself:

Changing your mindset does not mean controlling every thought that enters your mind. It means becoming more deliberate about which thoughts receive authority.

SECTION 4

04

WHAT STILL MATTERS?

Repair. Finish. Begin. Release. Four decisions — not ten, not a full life overhaul.

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One of the easiest ways to lose momentum is to treat every unfinished goal, unresolved issue, idea and responsibility as equally important. They are not. Some things still matter deeply. Some things mattered once but no longer fit. Some things were never really yours to begin with. The final months of the year do not need more noise. They need clearer priorities.

PART ONE — WHAT DESERVES YOUR ENERGY?

Look back at the goals, expectations and intentions you carried into this year. Which still feel meaningful? Which are you holding onto only because you once said you would?

What still matters enough to deserve my attention?

What am I continuing out of guilt, habit or expectation?

What can I consciously decide not to carry into the final months of the year?

PART TWO — FOUR DECISIONS

For the rest of this programme, reduce your focus to four deliberate choices.

1 · SOMETHING TO REPAIR

What in your life would benefit from deliberate repair? A relationship, your health, your finances, your routine, your confidence, or something you have neglected for too long.

I want to repair:

Why does this matter?

What is one realistic first step?

2 · SOMETHING TO FINISH

Unfinished things carry weight. Choose one thing that would create genuine relief, progress or momentum if you completed it before the year ends.

I want to finish:

Why has it remained unfinished?

What would completion actually require?

3 · SOMETHING TO BEGIN

A new beginning does not need to be dramatic. It may be one routine, one conversation, one application, one boundary, or one act of courage.

I want to begin:

Why now?

What is the smallest meaningful action I can take this month?

4 · SOMETHING TO RELEASE

Growth is not always about adding. This could be an expectation, resentment, habit, commitment, fear, comparison, or a version of yourself you have outgrown.

I am ready to release:

Why have I been holding onto it?

What becomes possible if I stop carrying it?

PART THREE — YOUR SEPTEMBER PRIORITY

Look at the four decisions you have made. You may care about all four, but one of them will probably have more leverage than the others.

**IF I COULD MAKE MEANINGFUL PROGRESS
IN ONLY ONE AREA THIS MONTH,
WHICH ONE WOULD IMPROVE THE REST OF MY LIFE MOST?**

My September priority is:

By 30 September, progress would look like:

Make the outcome concrete enough that you will know whether movement actually happened. Clarity makes accountability possible.

PART FOUR — WHAT WILL YOU PROTECT?

Choosing a priority is only half the work. Most meaningful changes fail not because they were impossible, but because they were repeatedly displaced by something more immediate.

What usually steals time or attention from what matters to me?

What boundary would make this priority easier to protect?

What will I need to say no to more often?

What will I need to say yes to more consistently?

THE STANDARD FOR THE MONTH

**REPAIR WHAT STILL DESERVES CARE.
FINISH WHAT STILL DESERVES COMPLETION.
BEGIN WHAT STILL DESERVES A CHANCE.
RELEASE WHAT NO LONGER DESERVES YOUR ENERGY.**

You are not trying to become a completely different person before October. You are deciding what kind of person your next decisions will begin to support. That is enough for now.

SECTION 5

05

THE 30-DAY STANDARD

Clarity without behaviour changes very little. This is where it becomes simple — not easier, simpler.

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For the next thirty days, you do not need to solve everything. You need to create evidence that your direction is changing. A single good day can feel powerful, but it does not necessarily change a pattern. A small action repeated consistently often does.

PART ONE — THREE COMMITMENTS

Choose three commitments for September. Keep them specific enough that you can recognise whether you followed through — avoid vague commitments such as “be more disciplined.” Instead, choose actions you can observe: “I will walk three times a week.” “I will review my finances every Friday.”

COMMITMENT 1

This month, I will:

Why this matters:

COMMITMENT 2

This month, I will:

Why this matters:

COMMITMENT 3

This month, I will:

Why this matters:

PART TWO — THE STANDARD YOU ARE CHOOSING

Goals describe what you want to achieve. Standards describe how you intend to behave. You cannot control every outcome. You can control far more of your behaviour.

A goal might be: "I want to feel healthier." A standard might be: "I move my body four times a week, protect my sleep, and stop treating exhaustion as normal."

For September, the standard I am choosing is:

When I am tempted to fall back into old patterns, I want to remember:

PART THREE — THE WEEKLY CHECK-IN

Once a week, stop long enough to notice what is happening. Ten honest minutes is enough. The purpose is not to judge the week — it is to correct direction while there is still time.

WEEKLY REVIEW

What did I do well this week?

Where did I lose focus?

Which commitment did I keep most consistently?

Which commitment needs more attention?

What got in the way?

Is that obstacle temporary, or is it a pattern I need to address?

What is one adjustment I will make next week?

What am I grateful for from this week?

Repeat this review each week. Do not aim for four perfect weeks. Aim for four honest ones.

PART FOUR — WHEN YOU MISS

At some point this month, you may miss a workout, lose focus, or have a week that looks nothing like the one you planned. That does not invalidate the month.

Progress is rarely destroyed by one imperfect moment. It is more often lost through the decision not to return.

When you miss, do not make the mistake larger than it is. Notice it. Understand it. Adjust. Return. That is all.

If I lose momentum this month, my reset action will be:

PART FIVE — THE END-OF-MONTH REVIEW

At the end of September, return to the beginning of this journal. Read what you wrote. Look at the scores you gave yourself. Look at the four decisions you made around what to repair, finish, begin and release. Then answer the following.

What changed this month?

What did I follow through on?

Where was I still inconsistent?

What did I learn about myself?

Which old pattern showed up again? How did I respond differently this time?

What am I proud of?

What still needs work?

What do I want to carry into October?

THE FINAL QUESTION

Return now to the question from the beginning of this journal:

IF THE YEAR WERE GOING TO END DIFFERENTLY, WHAT WOULD HAVE TO CHANGE NOW?

After thirty days, your answer may be different. That is a good thing. Growth should give you new information.

My answer now is:

. . .

CHANGE THE ENDING

You were never asked to fix the entire year in September. You were asked to stop treating the months behind you as instructions for the months ahead. That is different.

You cannot change every circumstance. You cannot control every outcome. You cannot recover every missed opportunity. But you can still choose what you do next.

You can still repair what matters. You can still finish what deserves completion. You can still begin what deserves a chance. You can still release what no longer deserves your energy. And you can still become more deliberate about the person you are carrying into the final months of the year.

A different ending rarely begins with one dramatic decision. It usually begins quietly — with a clearer thought, a better boundary, a kept promise, a difficult conversation, a repeated action, a decision to return when it would be easier to quit.

**THE YEAR IS NOT OVER.
NEITHER ARE YOU.**
